

John Crowe The Early Bird



MOVE OVER, RICH LITTLE, on May 23, 13-year-old Loren Redburn will be seen on the Gong Show. Loren has been entertaining his school-mates at Tenaya Junior High School for some time with impressions of his teachers. He even claims the teachers enjoy it.

His mother, Sue Redburn, suggested trying out for the Gong Show. On the first trip to Los Angeles for a tryout, Loren auditioned with 500 other hopefuls. He did imitations of rock star Peter Frampton and of Chuck Barris, producer-director of the show.

Barris saw the act on video tape and invited Loren back for a second tryout. At the end, Loren was among 40 persons who got on one week of shows. Loren tied for second, losing by only one point.

"Some of the acts were pretty good," he said. "But the others — if you think I'm bad, you should see them."

We have. They go beyond the bizarre. Couldn't decide between the girl who gargled the Tales of the Vienna Woods or the guy who ate three kazooks.

WHILE PRESIDENT CARTER was mending political fences and saying he didn't realize how serious the drought is (come on, Jimmy), our beloved governor took the opportunity to work the crowds, shrewd politician that he is.

Let Carter mend his fences — Jerry was rounding up the votes, shaking hands like the next presidential primary was only weeks away. It's never too early to start.

Grower Jake Minasian cornered Brown and berated him for supporting Prop. 13, the farm labor initiative.

Then Minasian switched topics, talking about selling more raisins.



"I'm doing my part," replied Brown. "I eat Raisin Bran for breakfast every morning."

Minasian said he would like to give Brown some raisins but had given his only package to the President.

"That's okay," said Brown. "I'll buy my own."

The crowd loved it. But Carter also is shrewd. Those who have underestimated him in the past are known as losers. When Carter saw a sign which said, "Welcome President Carter, love from the Centerville School," he directed an aide to be sure a note of thanks is sent to the school.

Those who couldn't attend the President's arrival at the Fresno Air Terminal or join in on the tour got a good laugh when they tuned in on Channel 30 for the late news.

The sound synchronization was way off and there was our President, speaking in a high, chipmunk voice.

Final note: As the President's jet winged away, workers began dismantling the rope barriers in front of the crowd. The ropes were attached to 55-gallon barrels. The barrels contained water for ballast. The water was dumped on the runway.

So much for Carter's plea to conserve water.

THOUGHT FOR TODAY: It was Mark Twain who said, "Let us be thankful for the fools; but for them, the rest of us could not succeed."



The group gathered just a block away from the abduction site.



A reflection of fear.

Neighborhood Banded In Fear

By PETER H. KING
Bee Staff Writer

About one hundred parents and children gathered under a breeze-tossed tree in Southeast Fresno early Thursday evening for a neighborhood meeting. Murder topped their agenda.

The meeting spot was the front yard of the Leroy Smith residence, 2031 S. Woodrow Ave. — just around the corner from where 17-year-old Janet Herstein was abducted Monday before being raped, murdered and discarded near Mendota.

Officials believe the young newspaper carrier was the fifth victim from the neighborhood to fall prey to a killer-rapist who is still at large.

Those who attended the hour-long meeting came seeking ways to make sure there isn't a sixth.

"It's up to us," Henry Delgado told the crowd. "We're the parents and we have to protect our children ourselves."

"We can't depend on the police coming right down just because we call them. They have lots of other calls."

Added Alice Smith, a mother of three who along

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The neighborhood fathers.

'New' Fresno City College Dedication Sunday

By MIKE LASSITER
Bee Staff Writer

In 1956, Fresno City College bought the old Fresno State College campus on University Avenue for \$1 million.

It was more than CC officials wanted to spend. But by today's standards, it was a steal.

On Sunday, by comparison, the remodeled CC campus will be rededicated. The seven-year program, which saw the construction of 12 new buildings, ran up a tab of \$28 million.

The result has been the replacement of about three-quarters of the classrooms and a change in the face of the campus.

The rededication ceremonies will take place at 3 p.m. in the central campus area. Assemblyman Richard Lehman, a former CC student body president, will be the featured speaker.

The ceremonies will be combined with a campus open house from 1:30 to 4:30 p.m.

Besides tours of the campus, there will be music and refreshments. In addition, many of the departments will put on demonstrations.

A complete list of events will be passed out to visitors as they arrive on campus.

Oddly enough, the rebuilding program was prompted by the same reason which led college

officials to buy the campus in the first place — earthquake safety.

In 1952, engineers found two buildings at the Stanislaus and O Streets campus of what was then Fresno Junior College to be earthquake hazards.

More than a decade later, the Field Act set earthquake resistance standards for school buildings which much of the University Avenue campus could not meet.

That prompted the rebuilding program, which began in with the expansion of the Library and ended earlier this year with the occupation of the new Administration Building.

The major link with the past is the Library. However, there is still a chance the old Administration Building can be saved as a state agricultural museum. If not, the State Center Community College District plans to level the historic structure and replace it with a parking lot.

In redoing the campus, architect Paul Schoenwald said, an attempt was made to tie the old buildings with the new in the use of tile roofs and substantial amounts of brick.

He said the project posed logistics problems as it required the tearing down of buildings and construction of new ones at

the same time that students were on campus.

Schoenwald said as much as possible the new buildings were designed to separate the classroom areas from vehicular traffic and parking lots.

Since CC began as the state's first junior college in 1910 it has grown from 20 students to 17,000. It started with three instructors and this year employed 273 full-time and 288 part-time teachers.

The growth is also reflected in the building program. Ten of the new buildings were needed to replace facilities once contained in the Old Administration Building.

'No Corpse' Murder Trial For Two Men

By ELEANOR HANNAH
Bee Staff Writer

In a rarity in California courts, two men Thursday were bound over for Superior Court trial on charges of murdering a Clovis woman whose body has never been found.

Clarence Ray Allen, 47, of Sanger, owner of Ray Allen Security Patrol, and Eugene Leland Furrow, 26, of San Diego, were ordered to stand trial late yesterday by Clovis Justice Court Judge John P. Zylka after two days of grisly testimony.

Mary Sue Kitts, 18, was reported missing by her parents in November, 1974 and law enforcement investigators said they had no inkling that she could have been a homicide victim until they received a tip some five months ago.

An investigation was launched by Sheriff's detectives Art Christensen and Tom Lean, ending with the pair being charged early last month.

Charles E. Jones, 31, a Tulare maintenance man, testified he had been given immunity from prosecution for his involvement, and then told a grim story.

He said he, Allen, Furrow and others had engaged in some burglaries and that one committed by only Allen

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With Assemblyman Richard Lehman, center, and Leo McCarthy in bemused attention, Gov. Brown explains why he likes to keep returning to Fresno.

Bee Photo

Buttoning The Governor

Brown Graces Lehman's Fresno Fund-Raiser

By ELISE TENICICH
Bee Politics Writer

Back in Fresno again for the second time in two days, Gov. Brown was almost acting like a native last night, playfully flashing a "Fresno Free-ways Now" button in his hand.

"Someone gave me this," he said as he, Assembly Speaker Leo McCarthy and Assemblyman Richard Lehman were adjusting their seats for a news conference.

"I'm trying to read it, trying to understand it," he said.

What puzzled him, the governor said slyly, is "why is there an 'S' on freeways. I thought you only wanted one."

But seriously, Brown told reporters, his administration is "taking a very careful look at highway projects to see what can be built."

Continuing what increasingly appears to be a conciliatory trend in his freeway construction stand, the governor said a "new look" is being taken at revenues and construction costs to see if there is way possible to resume work on the Fresno system.

The findings of that, he said, could be known in a "few months...a few weeks."

Brown and McCarthy were in Fresno last night for a \$50-a-couple fund-raising dinner for Lehman that attracted an estimated 800 persons.

"I think I might be out of debt,"

said the Fresno Democrat surveying the jolly crowd assembled in the backyard of the Gary Brown residence on N. Marks Ave.

But he may not be out of the woods with Brown and McCarthy on a subject dear to the two leaders' hearts — the death penalty. Lehman voted to restore it, McCarthy voted against it, and Brown says he will veto any capital punishment bill.

Noting that the vote in the Assembly to override the governor's veto "could be very close," McCarthy said he intends to "make my views known" to his Democratic colleagues in an effort to change enough minds to sustain the governor.

As McCarthy talked about appealing to the conscience of his fellow lawmakers, Brown glanced at Lehman quickly and murmured, "How about you?"

Lehman answered with a mini smile.

As for his own position on the death penalty legislation, Brown repeated his determination to work against an override of any veto. "My views haven't changed," he insisted.

In a jovial mood reminiscent of his father when he was governor, Brown defended his new outgoing, on-the-move style.

He keeps coming back to the San Joaquin Valley and points north and

south because "one shouldn't spend all his time in Sacramento," he said.

"I intend to meet with people throughout the state," he said, pointing out that his new Secretary of Agriculture, Richard Rominger, was with him, demonstrating their concern about the effects of the drought and about agriculture in general.

"We're in the process of opening up the administration," he said, repeating one of his more familiar phrases.

Brown, who accompanied President Carter on the President's aerial survey of the Sierra watersheds Tuesday, also lauded Carter for his travels away from Washington.

Asked if he thought the few hours the President allowed himself in the valley were enough to fully inform him of the consequences of the drought, Brown said the visit was "certainly better" than his not seeing it and hearing about it at all.

Like governors escaping their state houses, presidents "should get out of the White House."

Then, without so much as a mini smile of his own to betray any opposite thoughts he occasionally is suspected of harboring, Brown said of the quick presidential visit to the Golden State:

"It says something about how much President Carter cares about California."

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